SkillNavora

MODULE 13 HANDBOOK

Module 13: AI Automation Consulting and Agency Development

5 sections, every topic explained with how it works, examples and resources.

From Non-Coder to Enterprise AI Builder: Learn, Build, Deploy, Get Hired and Launch Your AI Business.

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Financial figures are hypothetical examples, not advice.

Module 13: AI Automation Consulting and Agency Development

Every section below explains the concept, how it works, each listed topic in detail, a worked example and where to learn more.

Sections

1. 13.1 Agency Fundamentals
2. 13.2 Automation Service Categories
3. 13.3 Industry Specialisation
4. 13.4 Commercial Delivery
5. 13.5 Agency Financial Planning

MODULE 13 · SECTION 13.1

13.1 Agency Fundamentals

DEFINITION

> An AI automation agency sells the design, build and support of automations and AI workflows to businesses. Consulting sells advice; SaaS sells software.

HOW IT WORKS

- Pick a niche (industry + problem) and a clear value proposition, for example 'we respond to every real-estate lead in under 60 seconds'.
- Package services: audit, build, retainer. Price by value and scope, not hours alone.
- Acquire clients with case studies, outreach, partnerships and referrals; use proposals and contracts that define scope, acceptance and payment.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

What an AI automation agency is; agency vs consulting vs SaaS. An AI automation agency designs, builds and maintains AI and automation solutions for clients. Agency: you deliver custom work. Consulting: you advise and plan. SaaS: you sell one product to many customers. Many start as an agency, then turn repeated solutions into SaaS.

Service business models; niche and target customer selection; value proposition. Service business models: project fees, monthly retainers, productised services (fixed scope and price). Niche selection: choose an industry and problem you understand. Target customer: the specific business type and decision-maker. Value proposition: the measurable outcome you deliver.

Service packaging, pricing, client acquisition, sales funnels, proposals, contracts, retainers. Service packaging: clear packages (Starter, Growth, Enterprise) with scope and deliverables. Pricing: value-based, fixed-fee or retainer. Client acquisition: referrals, LinkedIn, content, partnerships, cold outreach. Sales funnels: lead → call → audit → proposal → close. Proposals and contracts define scope, timeline, price, acceptance and IP. Retainers fund ongoing support and improvements.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> Offer: one-week automation audit ($500), lead-response system build ($3,000), monthly support and improvements ($400). All figures hypothetical.

RESOURCES

- HubSpot Academy (sales and marketing) https://academy.hubspot.com/
- Y Combinator Startup School https://www.startupschool.org/

13.2 Automation Service Categories

DEFINITION

> These are the services businesses most often buy: support, lead generation, sales and marketing, documents, reporting, internal assistants and voice agents.

HOW IT WORKS

- Customer support: AI answers common questions from a knowledge base and escalates the rest.
- Lead generation and CRM automation: capture, enrich, score and route leads.
- Document processing: extract fields from invoices, forms and contracts.
- Reporting: scheduled summaries from data. Employee assistants: answer internal policy questions. Voice agents: handle phone calls.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

AI customer support, lead generation, sales and marketing automation. AI customer support: chat and email assistants answer from a knowledge base and escalate. AI lead generation: find, enrich and qualify prospects. Sales automation: follow-ups, CRM updates, meeting booking. Marketing automation: content drafts, campaigns, segmentation.

Document processing, reporting, employee assistants, knowledge management. Document processing: extract data from invoices, forms and contracts. Reporting automation: scheduled reports and summaries from data. AI employee assistants: answer internal policy and process questions. Knowledge management: organise and search company knowledge.

Workflow automation, voice agents, email automation, CRM automation. Workflow automation: connect apps to remove manual steps. Voice agents: answer and make phone calls with speech-to-text and text-to-speech. Email automation: classify, route and draft replies. CRM automation: keep records accurate and up to date automatically.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> A clinic automation answers appointment questions on WhatsApp, books slots in the calendar, and sends reminders the day before.

RESOURCES

- n8n templates https://n8n.io/workflows/
- Zapier: automation guides https://zapier.com/blog/

13.3 Industry Specialisation

DEFINITION

> Specialising in an industry lets you reuse solutions and speak the client's language.

HOW IT WORKS

- Real estate: lead capture, qualification, property matching, follow-ups, visit scheduling, CRM updates.
- Education: student support, admissions questions, course assistants, progress tracking, fee reminders.
- Financial services: document extraction, application checks, exception flags and compliance support, always with human review for consequential decisions.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

Real estate: lead capture, qualification, recommendations, follow-ups, visit scheduling, CRM, documents, reporting. Real estate: capture leads from portals, website and WhatsApp; qualify by budget, location and timeline; recommend matching properties; send follow-ups; schedule site visits; update the CRM; process documents (KYC, agreements); report on pipeline and conversions.

Education: student support, admissions, course assistants, progress monitoring, fee reminders, counselling. Education: answer student and parent questions 24/7; support admissions (eligibility, documents, deadlines); course assistants explain concepts from course material; monitor progress and alert teachers; send fee reminders; support counselling with information while a human counsellor makes decisions.

Financial services: document extraction, application processing, validation, support, compliance support, exception detection. Financial services: extract data from statements, payslips and forms; check applications for completeness; validate against rules; answer customer queries; support compliance with checklists and audit trails; detect exceptions and inconsistencies for human review. Credit, lending and compliance decisions stay with authorised humans.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> A real-estate package qualifies leads by budget and area, sends three matching listings, and books visits, cutting response time from hours to minutes.

RESOURCES

- McKinsey: state of AI https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/quantumblack/our-insights/the-state-of-ai
- Google Cloud: AI use cases by industry https://cloud.google.com/transform/101-real-world-generative-ai-use-cases-from-industry-leaders

13.4 Commercial Delivery

DEFINITION

> Commercial delivery is the repeatable path from first call to a renewed client.

HOW IT WORKS

- Discovery → automation audit → workflow map → proposal → proof of concept → MVP → implementation → testing → deployment → training → support → renewal → case study.
- Each stage has an output the client signs off, which protects scope and payment.
- Measure results so the case study has real numbers.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

Discovery, automation audit, workflow mapping, proposal, proof of concept, MVP. Discovery understands the client's goals. An automation audit finds the best opportunities and estimates impact. Workflow mapping documents the as-is and to-be process. A proposal sets scope, price and timeline. A proof of concept proves feasibility on real data. An MVP delivers the first usable version.

Implementation, testing, deployment, training, support, renewal, case studies. Implementation builds the full solution. Testing verifies accuracy and edge cases. Deployment puts it live. Training teaches users. Support fixes issues and improves the solution. Renewal extends the contract. Case studies document results (with permission) to win new clients.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> After a two-week proof of concept shows 70% of enquiries answered automatically, the client signs a build plus a 6-month support retainer.

RESOURCES

- Atlassian: statement of work template https://www.atlassian.com/software/confluence/templates/statement-of-work
- HubSpot: proposal guide https://blog.hubspot.com/sales/business-proposal

13.5 Agency Financial Planning

DEFINITION

> Financial planning makes sure the agency earns more than it spends and knows when it breaks even. All numbers here are hypothetical examples with assumptions shown.

HOW IT WORKS

- Costs: tools and subscriptions, cloud and model usage, marketing, people.
- Revenue: project fees and monthly retainers. Gross margin = (revenue − direct costs) ÷ revenue.
- Customer acquisition cost (CAC) vs lifetime value (LTV); break-even = fixed costs ÷ margin per client.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

Startup and technology costs; software and infrastructure costs. Startup costs: laptop, registrations, website, legal templates. Technology costs: AI API usage, automation platform plans, hosting, domains. Software and infrastructure costs: CRM, email, design and project tools, cloud. All figures should be treated as hypothetical until checked against current prices.

Project pricing, retainers, gross margins, customer acquisition cost, lifetime value, break-even, forecasting. Project pricing: fixed fee per build based on value and effort. Retainers: monthly fee for support and improvements. Gross margin: revenue minus direct costs (APIs, contractors) divided by revenue. Customer acquisition cost (CAC): sales and marketing spend ÷ new clients. Lifetime value (LTV): average monthly profit per client × months retained.

All financial examples labelled as hypothetical, with assumptions shown. Break-even: the point where revenue covers all costs. Forecasting: project monthly revenue, costs and cash for 12 months using conservative, expected and optimistic cases. Every financial example in this programme is hypothetical, with assumptions shown, and is not financial advice.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> Hypothetical: fixed costs $1,200/month; each retainer earns $400 with $100 direct cost → $300 margin → break-even at 4 retainer clients.

RESOURCES

- SCORE: financial projections template https://www.score.org/resource/template/financial-projections-template
- Investopedia: break-even analysis https://www.investopedia.com/terms/b/breakevenanalysis.asp